

Game Foundry Studio

Messages Tool and Platform Reference Rules

Purpose: Capture design decisions for a future Messages tool and platform-wide asset reference management rules.

Recommended Tool Name

Messages

Reason: Broad enough for dialog, narration, quests, tutorials, signs, hints, accessibility, and text-to-speech.

Future PR #1 - Platform Reference Management Rules

Rule: Assets currently in use cannot be deleted.

Features:

- Usage Count
- View References
- Replace References
- Archive Asset
- Restore Asset
- Safe Delete (only when usage count = 0)

Platform Principle: Archive > Delete

Future PR #2 - Messages Tool

Game Journey Location: Design -> Messages

Purpose: Central repository for all game text and spoken content.

Message Structure

Message contains one or more ordered segments.

Each segment contains: Sequence, Speaker, Emotion, Text

Example

1. Narrator | Calm | The forest gets darker beyond this point.
2. Scout | Urgent | We are getting attacked by bats!

Emotions

Reusable project-wide definitions such as Calm, Happy, Sad, Excited, Urgent, Angry, Scared, Whisper, Narrator, and Robot.

Custom emotions are allowed.

Each emotion defines Voice, Tone, Pitch, Volume, Speech Rate, Typewriter Speed, and Pause Timing.

Design Principles

Messages define WHAT is said.

Emotions define HOW it is said.

Text To Speech generates audio from Messages and Emotions.

Tiles, Events, NPCs, and Quests determine WHEN it is said.